

Signs and symptoms of insomnia

Insomnia is difficulty in sleeping; sleeplessness, wakefulness and restlessness. One may have an inability to fall asleep or to remain sleeping long enough to feel rested. This is a problem, especially if the restlessness exists for a long time. The condition is not a disorder in itself but may be caused by any of various problems, such as physical disorders, fear, stress, anxiety, depression or stress. Insomnia can also be caused by an addiction to medications, caffeine, nicotine, alcohol or other heavier drugs. Insomnia is categorized depending on how long it lasts and how often it occurs.

Acute insomnia means that you suffer from sleep problems during a few weeks.

If you suffer from insomnia for a longer period (at least three nights/week for at least a month), you have *chronic* insomnia.

Insomnia test

Evaluate the statements below and select the option that you feel is reflecting the way you have been feeling for the past two weeks.

	True	Partly true	Not true
1. I often have trouble falling asleep at night	☐	☐	☐
2. I usually wake up several times during the night	☐	☐	☐
3. When I am awakened at night, I have trouble going back to sleep	☐	☐	☐
4. I have rambling thoughts at night that keep me awake	☐	☐	☐
5. It takes me longer than 30 minutes to fall asleep at night	☐	☐	☐
6. I often feel tension in the stomach when I try to sleep at night	☐	☐	☐
7. I often worry about tomorrow, which hinders me from falling asleep at night	☐	☐	☐

8. I feel hopelessly a victim to wakefulness	☐	☐	☐
9. I often tumble and turn before going to sleep at night	☐	☐	☐
10. I sometimes feel wide awake although my body feels tired	☐	☐	☐
11. My stress level seem high when I lie down to rest at night	☐	☐	☐
12. I feel discomfort during sleep time	☐	☐	☐
13. I feel tightness in the chest area when I try to sleep at night	☐	☐	☐
14. I experience excessive energy or fatigue at night but find it hard to sleep	☐	☐	☐
15. I often experience muscle contractions while trying to rest	☐	☐	☐
16. I feel stress when trying to sleep at night	☐	☐	☐
17. I often think negative thoughts while feeling tired	☐	☐	☐